CSC-192: Seminar #2
Lessons Learned from a Career in IT Entrepreneurship

Speaker: Gregory Kiefer – Retired technology CEO

(Answer the questions with full sentences)

Q1: As an entrepreneur, how do you stay motivated?
Greg Kiefer stays excited about his work by creating simple and smart software as fast as he can. He loves meeting new people, sharing ideas, and always learning something new. Every problem is like a puzzle he enjoys solving, and he likes finding better ways to do things. He also feels happy knowing he helps businesses make smarter choices using facts and numbers. Learning from others, getting good advice, and making sure he has the right people around him.

Q2: What do you do when a competitor has more resources? Marketing, research, sales team.
When going up against a bigger competitor, Greg Kiefer believes the first step is to really understand them. If there's something they don't do, maybe there's a way to work together instead of competing. He thinks it's important to stay confident, be creative, and show customers why you're the better choice. He also suggests paying attention to what the competitor shares, learning from it, and finding ways to make it even better.

Q3: What are your key driving factors that differentiate you from others?
Greg Kiefer always wanted to build something of his own, so he chose to work at a small company instead of big corporations. He's always been competitive—even telling his first boss he planned to become their biggest rival. He made strong connections by speaking at events and leading a large user group for 15 years. Instead of focusing on selling, he put all his energy into creating fast and efficient software. When challenges came, he adapted by hiring smart people and seeking advice. Even after retiring, his curiosity keeps him learning and asking questions to grow even more.

Q4: How should you lead your team?

Hire the Right People – Ensure the team is aligned with the company's goals.
Create a Collaborative Environment – Foster open communication and teamwork.
Lead by Example – Stay engaged, stay curious, and continue learning.
Embrace Challenges – Encourage resilience and innovation in the face of difficulties.

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Q5: When should you sell your business?

Greg Kiefer says you should sell your business when it feels right, like when it's doing great, the market is good, or your goals have changed. If you're not excited to grow it anymore or someone offers a deal that makes sense, it might be the right time. The key is to think it through and not just decide based on feelings.

Q6: Should you ever give your services away for free? Why?

Your free services can make sense in some situations, like when you're building relationships or gaining experience. It helps get your foot in the door, but it shouldn't be a regular thing. You should always make sure you're getting something in return, whether it's exposure or future opportunities, and know when to start charging for your skills.

Q7: Should you share your experiences with others so they can learn? Why?

According to Greg Kiefer, your experience is important because it helps others learn and grow. When you pass on what you've learned, you not only help them avoid mistakes but also build stronger connections. It's a way to give back and make the community better, plus it can lead to new opportunities for everyone.